

Austin Kranz

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Cloud DevOps Engineer

AWS Certified DevOps Engineer Professional with 5+ years of experience architecting and implementing multi-cloud infrastructure solutions across AWS and Azure. Proven track record of leading technical initiatives, driving org-wide infrastructure standards, and enabling engineering teams through reusable automation and well-defined deployment patterns.

Work Experience

Cloud Engineer | Electronic Arts | 10/2024 – Present

- Lead technical POCs and architecture decisions for critical infrastructure initiatives, presenting to engineering managers, directors, and architects to drive org-wide adoption.
- Serve as technical authority for EA Player Experience application infrastructure, spanning over 13 EKS clusters and multiple AWS accounts.
- Design reusable Terraform modules from scratch (AWS and Azure infra), author implementation documentation, and establish team-wide standards that enabled consistent, production-ready deployments across multiple applications.
- Drive standardization initiatives across the platform, implementing centralized configuration patterns and reusable templates that reduce deployment complexity and ensure consistency.
- Enable rapid adoption of emerging technologies by establishing infrastructure foundations and documentation that allow teams to independently deploy new capabilities.

DevOps Engineer | BuildASign.com | 07/2021 – 10/2024

- Authored BuildASign's CI/CD pipeline architecture as the company's first DevOps engineer, reducing deployment time and improving team productivity.
- Implemented infrastructure as code using Terraform and AWS CloudFormation to standardize application deployments.
- Collaborated with development and IT leadership to plan and implement the migration of BuildASign's entire application infrastructure into AWS.
- Established BuildASign's processes for container creation and orchestration, in support of a microservices architecture.

Engineering Operations | SolarWinds | 11/2020 – 07/2021

- Administered high-availability VMware vRealize Automation (vRA) cloud service clusters across 3 major data centers that serve SolarWinds developers around the globe.
- Troubleshoot issues with automated deployments of a wide range of desktop and server operating systems (Windows, Mac, Linux distributions) and services (Active Directory, SharePoint, Exchange, etc.).
- Customized and debugged PowerShell and Ansible automation scripts/playbooks for virtual machine and service deployments.
- Performed vRA service maintenance including patching, upgrades, and monitoring.

Skills and Competencies

Technical Skills

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS (EKS/ECS, Lambda, RDS, Bedrock, CloudFront), Azure (OpenAI, enterprise applications, Entra ID)
- **CI/CD & GitOps:** Jenkins, GitLab, AWS CodePipeline, ArgoCD
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Helm
- **Container Orchestration:** Kubernetes (EKS), ECS, Docker
- **Automation & Scripting:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, Ansible
- **Observability:** CloudWatch, ELK Stack, Prometheus, Grafana, Fluent Bit, Kafka, OpenSearch
- **Networking:** TCP/IP, DNS, VPC, load balancing, Traefik, NGINX

Leadership & Collaboration

- **Technical leadership:** Drive architecture decisions, conduct POCs, and establish infrastructure standards
- **Stakeholder management:** Present technical recommendations to engineering managers, directors, and architects
- **Knowledge sharing:** Enable teams through reusable components and clear, comprehensive documentation
- **Code quality & mentorship:** Provide technical guidance and code reviews for engineering teams
- **Problem-solving:** Identify inefficiencies and architect innovative solutions

Personal Enrichment

- Built and maintain a personal virtualized home lab to continuously hone DevOps skills, aiding preparation for the AWS Certified DevOps Engineer Professional and Kubernetes Certified Administrator exams.
- Guest lectured twice at Texas State University on DevOps practices for senior software engineering students.

Certifications

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| • AWS Certified DevOps Engineer – Professional
<i>Amazon Web Services (AWS)</i> | 01/2024 |
| • Google IT Automation with Python Professional
<i>Google</i> | 01/2023 |
| • Certified Kubernetes Administrator
<i>The Linux Foundation</i> | 06/2024 |

Education

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|---|-----------|
| Bachelor of Business Administration Computer Information Systems
Texas State University, San Marcos, TX | 2016-2020 |
| • Overall GPA: 3.63 | |